



CAPIZ STATE UNIVERSITY
BURIAS CAMPUS

EXTENSION CATEGORY

PAPER TITLE: **SALBAR SUBA**
(An Ecological Restoration Extension Program)

PROJECT LEADER: Prof. Mark L. Sibug

COMPONENT LEADERS:

Community Development/Capability Building
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Livelihood/ Entrepreneurship Program
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Tourism Development Program
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CAMPUS: BURIAS

CAMPUS EXTENSION PROGRAM: Community Development Extension Program
(CDEP)

BENEFICIARIES: Municipalities of Mambusao, Jamindan, Tapaz, Dumalag, Dao and Sigma

TIME FRAME/DURATION: 5 years

SALBAR SUBA
(An Ecological Restoration Extension Program)
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BURIAS, MAMBUSAO, CAPIZ

RATIONALE

Rivers and their floodplains provide fertile land for agriculture, water for consumption and irrigation, and a means of transporting goods and discarding waste. They have been providing a lot benefits to humanity due to their many uses and advantages. These benefits refer to environmental services, the gains that humans derive, directly and indirectly, from hydrologic systems (Brauman et al., 2007).

In the Philippines, there are a lot of rivers that abound in many of the country's islands. Such rivers provide shelter to many aquamarine plants and animals and they give lots of benefits to the people. However, water pollution in the country could never be denied. In fact, the pollution levels of Pasig River, Meycauyan River, and the Navotas, Malabon and Tulyahan river system have reached alarming stage and the people near these areas are confronted with water- and health- related problems due to the scarcity of clean water and the swelling of untreated waste water released into these rivers.

The Island of Panay has been so blessed with the presence of Panay River which continuously provides abundant benefits to various sectors in the locality. Panay River is one of the three important river basins in Western Visayas located in the province of Capiz. Eighty percent of the Capizenos are dependent on agriculture and aquaculture industries. Despite industrialization, a huge sector the Capizenos are farmers and the fisher folks who are dependent on the Panay River for their livelihood. Many farmers near the river rent generators to pump river waters to irrigate their rice fields. (Provincial Planning and Development Office, 2010).

The conceptualization and existence of Salbar-Suba Program was based on the results of the research conducted entitled Socio-Economic Status of Residents along Panay River: Basis for Preparing Ecological Restoration Program.

The study provides information on various ecological restoration concerns. Moreover, the results were used as basis for public, private and academic institutions to come up with projects and activities in line with ecological restoration. It is also deemed that residents living along Panay River and concerned agencies should work hand in hand in protecting and in preserving the Panay River. River restoration is a necessity because it can provide a better way of living.

OBJECTIVES OF THE PROGRAM

- Educate residents on the Importance of Ecological Restoration and Climate Change.
- Restore the Panay River through planting more trees.
- Educate Residents on Solid Waste Management.
- Organise “SALBAR SUBA” organization.

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

Prior to the conceptualization of the Salbar-Suba program, the results of the research study were presented to the local officials in the Municipality of Mambusao. The LGU officials then sought the assistance of Capiz State University-Burias Campus to extend its help by utilizing the expertise of its faculty. They requested the Campus to conduct trainings on Ecological Restoration so as to provide solutions to the problems encountered by the residents living along Panay River.

As a response to the needs of the LGU Officials, the SALBAR-SUBA” An Ecological Restoration Extension Program of CAPSU Burias started to exist. One of the major components of the said program, is to educate the residents living along the river about river restoration and help them identify the livelihood opportunities in the locality. In order to achieve this, the faculty and staff of CAPSU Burias conducted the Launching of SALBAR-SUBA Program which was participated by the LGU-Officials, Key Officials of the University and residents living along the river.

During the conduct of the training program, the following were among the topics that were discussed thoroughly by the faculty of the Campus: “Environmental Protection and Conservation” and “Solid Waste Management”; Tree planting activity was then initiated by the participants and fruit bearing trees that were planted was provided by CAPSU.

SALBAR-SUBA Program has three components; Community Development, Livelihood/Entrepreneurship Enhancement and Tourism Development Programs.

In order to monitor the sustainability of the said program and to find out if the knowledge and skills transfer to the recipients are put into practice, the Extension Chairperson of CAPSU conducts quarterly monitoring by attending the Local Government Unit Officials regular meeting. Moreover, a sustainability plan was created.

METHODOLOGY

Conduct Turning over of the Result of the Research Study to the different Local Government Units in the 2nd District of the Province of Capiz

Prof. Mark L. Sibug, Extension Chairperson have furnished copies of the results of the Research Study entitled “Stakeholders Partnership in the Rehabilitation of the Panay River” to the different municipalities in the second district of the Province of Capiz.

Conduct Consultative Meeting and Needs Assessment

CAPSU Burias conducted consultative meetings and needs assessment to find out what are the needs and concerns of the identified beneficiaries. Then, requested and made the packaged proposal based on the results of the Needs Assessment. And presented the proposal to the beneficiaries.

Launch and Sign Memorandum of Agreement (MOA)

The SALBAR-SUBA Program of CAPSU Burias was launched on February 13, 2023 at the Barangay Liboo, Mambusao, Capiz. Followed by the signing of Memorandum of Agreement between the Capiz State University – Burias and the LGU Officials.

Conduct of Trainings

After the launching of the SALBAR-SUBA Program, a set of seminars and trainings were conducted to the beneficiaries. The beneficiaries chose and attend trainings that are suited based on their interest and needs. The trainings conducted were: Training on Environment Protection and Conservation, Training on Solid Waste Management, Training on Hydroponics and Coconut Production.

Tree Planting Activity

CAPSU Burias faculty, staff and students conducted tree planting activity in upstream and downstream areas in the different towns in the second district of the Province of Capiz.

Monitoring and Evaluation

In order to monitor the sustainability of the said program and to find out if the knowledge and skills transfer to the recipients are put into practice, the Extension Chairperson of CAPSU conducts quarterly monitoring by attending the Local Government Unit Officials regular meeting.

RESULTS OF THE INTERVENTION

To find out if the conduct of the SALBAR-SUBA Program has derived positive effects, quarterly monitoring is conducted. The following are the observed results:

1. Knowledge on Ecological Restoration and Climate Change Awareness were enhanced among Residents living along the Panay River;
2. Capiz State University Burias Campus conducted tree planting activity along the Panay River in the Municipality of Mambusao ;
3. Knowledge on Solid Waste Management among Residents living along Panay River was amplified and Material Recovery Facility (MRF) was established; and
4. Salbar Suba Organization was formed.

LESSONS LEARNED

1. Capiz State University-Burias Campus, being an institution of higher learning, plays a significant role in protecting and conserving environment and promoting human development in its immediate community.
2. What goes around, comes around. What the Institution has provided to the community is unconditionally paid back by the residents and has become more supportive to the activity of CAPSU and vice versa, thus creating a mutual exchange of resources and assistance.
3. The Residents living along the Panay River when given the chance to be more knowledgeable in terms of ecological restoration can be more empowered and more driven in the portrayals of their roles and responsibilities in the community.
4. Knowing the fact that majority of the residents have not attained higher degree of education, however their motivation to lead and to serve their community is beyond compared. There is an increasing demand to share the knowledge for them to channel their innate drive into something which is in accordance to what is expected from them to deliver.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Since CAPSU Burias has drawn out positive results from the first component of the project, the Campus is now ready to extend the project to other municipalities in the Province of Capiz. Thus, the support and cooperation of the Local Government Unit and Non-Government Organizations should be solicited prior to widening its scope.
2. Constant monitoring by the Campus should be conducted to ensure the sustainability of the project.
3. Salbar-Suba Program should be conducted by the Campus not only in the adopted towns but also to other localities in the province.
4. CAPSU should continuously assists the residents to strengthen its capabilities and resources to better uplift their standard of living.

AWARDS/RECOGNITION

SALBAR-SUBA program was presented during the World Water Day 2023: International Sharing of Greening Practices, sponsored by Iloilo Science and Technology University and Metro Iloilo Water District and received certificate of recognition.